



Grace was a very curious child. She once took apart seven different clocks to find out how they worked!



Computer scientists, or coders, write the instructions that tell computers what to do. Computers only understand one language, called binary. It's a language that uses just two digits: 0 and 1. This sounds pretty simple, but it's hard for humans to read and write in binary. Grace Hopper created tools that made it possible to give computers instructions using familiar words, rather than 0s and 1s. Her work made it easier for humans to tell computers what to do.

Grace's journey into the exciting world of computer science started with mathematics. She studied math to the highest level possible, then found a practical way to use her skills by joining the US Navy during World War II. Grace was assigned to the Bureau of Ships Computation Project at Harvard University.



Coders use the word "bug" to describe a problem with computer code that needs to be fixed. This comes from the time Grace found a real insect stuck in a computer that was stopping it from working properly!

GRACE HOPPER

American computer scientist and
US Navy officer • 1906–1992